

Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...'

Lineup at TD Club Meeting

THE MEN IN THE LINEUP, reading from the witnesses' left, are Bobby Dobbs, Bruno Rolack, Andy Cohen, Don Haskins and his accomplice, Jerry Hale, and Wayne Vandenburg.

They all have a record. They're not first time losers. That is all except Rolack. He hasn't lost yet. As coach of the U.T. El Paso wrestling team he is the only undefeated man on the stage at the Touchdown Club's spring meeting at the Sheraton Motor Inn.

Rolack, in his first season as coach of the college edition of the grunt and groaners, had an 8-0 record in dual competition.

That included a match with University of Texas, at Austin. The only other college in the state that has a wrestling team.

The Miners accepted a challenge from the Austin branch. That institution didn't have enough money, he said, to send its wrestlers out here. He added, "we did," looking at athletic director George McCarty, "have enough to go to Austin." Having wiped out the only other team in the state, Rolack and his matmen are claiming the championship of Texas. "And," said Rolack, "we don't have a senior on the team."

Loss of Pearce Demoralizing

VANDEBURG WAS pretty unhappy about the showing of his cinder men in the NCAA Indoor meet in Detroit. He mumbled something about jumping off a bridge but then he got more optimistic as he went on, predicting an NCAA title for UTEP before he quit coaching and added he hoped to be coaching at the school in 1989 or somewhere thereabouts.

Vandy said the injury to Kerry Pearce, the Miners' great two-miler, had a big emotional impact on his team at Detroit. And the vagaries of the scoring kept two of his athletes, Danny Tague and Scott English, from placing even though they came right close to the winning time and height in the 600-yard dash and the high jump.

Contacts Made With Tall Boys

HASKINS, TELLING about the Miners' 16-9 season, said the turning point came when Colorado State nipped his team by one point at Fort Collins. The Miners lost five out of six games at that point and thus were probably prevented from getting an NCAA or NIT bid.

Haskins ticked off the names of a number of prospects of the desired height the Miners need in the future. There were some 6-10, 6-8 and 6-7 players. And there were some smaller players too. Little runts like some 6-2 and 6-3 guards. Bringing them in and getting them through the registrar's office and getting them eligible are major steps yet to be taken by Don and his assistant, Jerry Hale.

Dobbs Is Ready ... Andy 7-2

BOBBY DOBBS spoke of the start of spring football practice Saturday. He said the Miners will have a squad of 80 broken down into 20 seniors, 24 juniors and 36 sophomores. Six junior college transfers will supplement the men who return from previous varsity seasons at UTEP or come up from a freshman season.

Dobbs and his staff went after two quarterbacks but lost one to UCLA and one to Alabama. Their recruiting, however, was termed pretty satisfactory. They got six out of 10 players in the El Paso area they went after.

Andy Cohen pointed to his 7-2 record this season but said the toughest part is coming up. In his seventh season as the Miners' baseball coach without salary, he said the biggest kick he's gotten so far happened in the first game after he became coach. The Miners defeated New Mexico, co-champion of the Western Athletic Conference, 7-6.

It's a good lineup and the crowd agreed with George McCarty that it would be hard to find a better one.